David Almona

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EDUCATION

Centre College **2022 – May 2026**

Bachelor of Science in Economics & Finance (Major), Data Science (Minor) *Danville, KY*

- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.64 | **Major GPA:** 3.78
- **Relevant Coursework:** Modern Calculus I, Applied Machine Learning, Statistical Modeling, Econometrics, Empirical Analysis, Data Visualization, Intro to Management, Programming and Problem Solving, Economics of College Sports, Managerial Finance.
- **Leadership & Activities:** Track and Field Student-Athlete | Resident Assistant | Co-President: Centre Brother-to-Brother Club.
- **Programming Languages & Tools:** R, Python, SQL, Stata, Tableau, Power BI, Git/GitHub, Microsoft Office.

EXPERIENCE

Basketball Analytics Intern **Feb 2026 - Present**

Los Angeles Sparks *Remote*

- Create statistical player comparisons and analyze individual and team performance to support roster and game strategy decisions.
- Scrape and compile data from public websites to build and maintain internal analytics databases and projection models.
- Contribute to game-by-game, seasonal, and player evaluation reports, including league-wide trend research.

Business Program Development Fellow **Sep 2025 – Dec 2025**

Sustainable Business Network (SBN) of Massachusetts *Cambridge, MA*

- Developed the Technical Assistance Pilot Program from scratch to connect local food micro-entrepreneurs with specialized consultants at affordable prices.
- Designed multi-step intake process including dual Google Forms (20+ questions each), interview framework, database management system, and memorandum of understanding template.
- Facilitated consultee interviews to identify foundational business gaps and matched businesses with consultants based on readiness, expertise alignment, and availability.

Undergraduate Research Fellow **Jun 2025 – Jul 2025**

Carnegie Mellon University - Statistics & Data Science | *Capstone Project* *Pittsburgh, PA*

- 1 of 16 students selected for a fully funded 8-week research program.
- Developed machine learning models to predict pressing effectiveness in professional soccer using 252,646 sequences from 502 MLS matches, using 10Hz player tracking data provided by SkillCorner.
- Oral presentation at the Carnegie Mellon Sports Analytics Conference 2025 & American Soccer Insights Summit 2026.

Data Analytics: Qualitative & Quantitative Insights Extern **Mar 2025 – Jun 2025**

Beats by Dr. Dre | *Capstone Project* *Remote*

- Analyzed 4,500+ consumer survey responses and scraped product reviews using Python (Pandas, NumPy, TextBlob) and AI tools (Claude, Gemini) to identify market opportunities, purchase drivers, and feature preferences for wireless speaker product launch.
- Delivered strategic assessment recommending $150-250 price point based on consumer insights, demographic segmentation, sentiment analysis, and competitive gap analysis.

PROJECTS

Chasing Imperfect Passes: Into the Life of a Receiver | 2026 NFL Big Data Bowl | *R* | *View* **Sep 2025 – Dec 2025**

- Analyzed how quarterback ball placement alters receiver movement while the ball is in the air.
- Developed a placement-based metric that captures receiver adjustment through trajectory deviation, acceleration, and turning behavior.

Predicting MLB Player Usage | Cincinnati Reds Baseball Analytics Student Hackathon | *R* | *View* **Jan 2025 – Feb 2025**

- Worked with 2.1M+ pitch-by-pitch Baseball Savant data points to build roster-agnostic batter and pitcher usage features.
- Used elastic net regression to model player availability based on pitch mix, performance trends, and biographical factors.

National Olympic Performance: Determinants of Medal Counts | Econometrics | *Stata* | *View* **Sep 2024 - Dec 2024**

- Analyzed how economic, demographic, and historical factors relate to national medal counts across multiple Summer Olympics.
- Built and compared panel regression models with country fixed effects to address unobserved heterogeneity and model specification issues.

Minesweeper | Programming and Problem Solving Course Final Project | *Python* | *View* **Sep 2024 – Dec 2024**

- Built a fully playable Minesweeper game with both text-based and graphical interfaces, including difficulty selection and flagging mechanics.
- Implemented core game logic such as safe first-click handling, recursive cell reveals, and win/loss detection.

MENTORSHIP

Mentee, 2026 NFL Big Data Bowl Mentorship Program | Mentee, WeStutter@Work Mentorship Program | Selected Participant, Philadelphia Eagles Virtual Development Series (Business Operations)